of multiple teams? Shift the responsibility there. You may need to modify the proposed tree and add intermediary levels. We suggest identifying the split point on the general structure. This approach is much more robust than allowing some, maybe even more experienced, product owners to make their own rules, different from those adhered to by others.

6.4.2 Extreme ends of data governance models

As we previously mentioned, depending on your organization's needs, your governance model could be positioned on a scale between centralized data governance and decentralized data governance. Let's look at these models in a bit more detail, because to design any hybrid solution, you will need to select and combine elements from both.

CENTRALIZED DATA GOVERNANCE MODEL: TOP-DOWN DECISION FLOW

As we mentioned previously, a top-down management model is at one extreme of data governance. In this case, a single governance body or even a single person makes decisions and shapes all data governance.

This approach has some benefits. For example, decision-making in smaller environments may be highly time-effective. Usually, the centralized governance model also assumes central control over the costs of data-related operations—it implies a much higher level of control and ease of financial planning. The other benefit may be clarity of reporting structure. Because all the reports are directed to a central governance body, there isn't much space for misinterpretations and oversimplifications, which are common at report collation by middle management. Also, the central governance team should have access to the expertise required to fulfill legal obligations, whereas expecting every product owner to have such capability may be too optimistic. Finally, a centralized approach makes ensuring master and metadata cohesiveness easier from a pure data perspective. A single body owning its setting can ensure that data consumers' requests are introduced in a way that does not disrupt any data areas.

The most obvious cons of this approach are the rigidity of the whole setup and stripping freedom of choice from the development level. While this approach may be a viable option for a smaller organization, but with an